# Miles Mattson

**QA/QE | Game Designer | Unity Developer**
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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Recent graduate with a B.A. in Digital Narrative and Interactive Design (University of Pittsburgh, May 2026) and hands-on experience in game development, QA processes, and Agile workflows. Experienced in Unity (C#), Jira-based ticket tracking, documentation, and cross-disciplinary collaboration. I aim to combine a developer's understanding of game systems with a designer's eye for user experience. My previous work with version control and practices taught me to avoid merge conflicts, such as making new files when possible and communicating with team members to make sure any existing files are not actively being worked on. Furthermore, I am well-positioned to identify, reproduce, and communicate defective code at every stage of implementation.

## SKILLS

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| **QA & Testing** | Defect identification & reproduction, defect reporting, regression testing, playtest feedback analysis, build validation |
| **Tools** | Jira (ticket-based workflow), Figma / FigJam (Workflows, logic loops, and UI/UX design), Adobe software (photoshop, acrobat, Premiere Pro, ect), Unity Editor (development with C#), Git / GitHub (version control), Chrome DevTools (Backend methods implementation for websites), Claude (rapid iteration and documentation clarification) |
| **Programming** | C# (Unity scripting), C++ (Unreal Engine), Java (general object oriented development), JavaScript (dynamic content), HTML (static content), CSS (website UI/UX development), |
| **Methodologies** | Agile / Scrum (sprint-based iteration), scope management (Realistic analysis of progress made to ensure products are as defect free as possible for any deadlines), playtest-driven feature prioritization (based off of user preference assessing what is most important to implement), Jira ticket management (Organization of work to ensure there are no merge conflicts when working with version control systems) |
| **Design** | Level design (collaborating with the art team to make a section of the game that the user will intuitively progress while also ensuring art assets are optimally utilized), encounter design (collaborating with the development team to ensure ideas are feasible on our time scale and working to make user experiences that compound on systems and generate unique and joyful experiences within realistic bounds), narrative/systems design (Writing enthralling environmental details and narrative arcs that drive the user to engage with developed systems), UI/UX (Designing the user experience to be intuitive and minimize cognitive load), design documentation (Clearly articulating how systems should interact with the user and what the effects of the interactions have on systems) |
| **Soft Skills** | Attention to detail, clear written and verbal communication, cross-team collaboration, active listening, open to constructive criticism, growth mindset |

## EXPERIENCE

**Game Designer & Developer (Part-Time)** | *Pixel Diamond Games* Aug 2022 – Present

- Worked within an Agile development pipeline using Jira for task tracking, naming all commits by Jira ticket number to maintain traceability across the codebase and keep the team aligned across sprints while avoiding merge conflicts.
- Utilized Github for version control to ensure a productive workflow as many collaborators work in sync to avoid merge conflicts. I was responsible for my own commits, in addition to others when my project manager was too busy to look them over.
- Actively managed scope throughout the project by collaborating with the project lead to prioritize features, flag potential scope creep early, and make informed decisions about what to implement versus defer, keeping development on track and focused.
- Participated in iterative playtests, observing user sessions, documenting gameplay or logical issues and friction points, and working with the project lead to reprioritize the sprint backlog based on real user feedback.
- Designed and implemented a full two-phase boss fight from design document through minimum viable product. Initially coding cubes to interact with the user. Rapidly refactoring code to cancel defects and flaws in the code's logic. In this time the project lead and I solved over one hundred errors, either in code logic or compiling errors. In two months time, when the code was interacting with the user without error, art assets were added. With just the project lead and I we managed to develop a minimum viable product 60% faster than the team's previous boss fight. My contributions continued to improve in quantity and quality as I tightened the design-to-implementation loop.
- Implemented and corrected defective gameplay systems in Unity (C#), including collision, AI behavior, dialogue triggers, performing functional testing at each integration stage to catch issues early.
- Leveraged Claude Code and built in Visual Studio Code AI to accelerate development tasks such as scripting, documentation drafts, and design ideation, while applying a critical review process to validate correctness and catch errors before integration.
- Developed a dialogue system architected for forward compatibility, enabling future voice line and subtitle integration without reworking any systems. Tested system behavior across multiple dialogue branches to ensure stability.
- Used Figma / FigJam to collaborate on UI/UX layout and encounter design, contributing to visual consistency and usability reviews.
- Produced design documentation including encounter specs, gameplay loop diagrams, and enemy archetypes to align team expectations before implementation began.
- Networked at industry gatherings such as the Game Developers Conference (GDC), Penny Arcade Expo (PAX West), and Game Developers Expo (GDEX), attending insightful talks and meeting other likeminded creators.

**Capstone Project: The Narrator** | *University of Pittsburgh* Spring 2026

- Served as the designer and developer in a team of my classmates on a first-person narrative Unity game set on a Martian colony, featuring branching dialogue, a multi-faction consequence system, four distinct endings, and a hidden secret ending.
- Managed the full project scope independently, setting milestones, adjusting priorities as development revealed new challenges, and keeping the core experience focused and shippable within the semester timeline.
- Conducted iterative self-testing and peer playtesting throughout development, identifying and resolving issues with dialogue state management, scene transitions, and UI clarity.
- Performed build validation for Windows, Mac, and HTML deployment, diagnosing and resolving platform-specific issues including compression format compatibility with GitHub Pages hosting.

**Game Development Course** | *iD Tech — Carnegie Mellon University* July 2017

- Completed intensive program in Unreal Engine; greyboxed levels using free assets, collaborating with a team to integrate mechanics into a growing system.

## EDUCATION

**B.A. in Digital Narrative and Interactive Design** | *University of Pittsburgh* 2021 – May 2026

- Major blending narrative design, game development, and programming — coursework in systems design, interactive storytelling, and game production workflows.
- Capstone: The Narrator — a Unity game demonstrating narrative systems, playtest iteration, and unique endings based off of user choices.

## WHY QA

Working at Pixel Diamond Games taught me how catching defects early matters. I have seen firsthand how a small issue left unchecked can snowball into something that affects the whole experience, and I developed a habit of testing thoroughly at every stage rather than waiting until the end. I thrive in close-knit teams where I can make a real impact, and QA is where I can do that while also growing my understanding of how games are built. I naturally integrate QA thinking into every stage of development, catching issues early, documenting clearly, and feeding findings back into the pipeline in a way that keeps the team moving forward rather than backtracking. That mindset makes me useful beyond just finding bugs, as it means I actively contribute to a smoother, faster, and higher-quality production cycle.